

Comprehensive Sentiment Mapping & Word List

How to read this table:

- High Severity: Explicit hate speech, slurs, or highly toxic terms found in your capstone datasets (DGHS/MLMA). Action: Immediate Flag.
- Medium Severity: Stereotypes, coded language, or "othering" terms. Action: Warning / "Check Context".
- Low Severity: Exclusionary corporate jargon or subtle gendered language. Action: Coaching tip.

1. Race, Ethnicity, & National Origin

Sources: [MLMA Dataset \(Hate Class\)](#), [DGHS Dataset](#), [Ongig: Biased Language List](#), [SHRM: Inclusive Language](#)

Term / Phrase	Severity	Context / Rationale
N-word (variants)	● High	Slur. Top frequency in MLMA/DGHS. Zero tolerance.
Spic / Wetback / Beaner	● High	Slur (Hispanic). Dehumanizing.
Chink / Ching Chong / Chinaman	● High	Slur (Asian). Mockery of language/features (MLMA top terms).
Raghead / Towelhead	● High	Slur (Middle Eastern/Sikh). Religious/ethnic insult.
Gook	● High	Slur (Asian). Violent history.
Kike	● High	Slur (Jewish). Antisemitic.
Savage / Primitive	● High	Racist/Colonial. Dehumanizing to Indigenous peoples.

Ghetto / Ratchet	● Medium	Coded Racism. Often applied to Black women/culture.
Thug / Gangster	● Medium	Coded Racism. Criminalizing Black men.
"You people" / "Those people"	● Medium	Othering. Creates "us vs. them" dynamic.
"Illegal" (noun)	● Medium	Dehumanizing. Reduces a person to legal status. Use "Undocumented".
"Articulate" (surprised tone)	● Medium	Microaggression. Implies expectation of lower intelligence for POC.
"Clean" (appearance)	● Medium	Microaggression. Implies natural hair/features are "dirty".
Peanut Gallery	● Low	Historical Racism. Refers to segregated seating sections.
Grandfathered in	● Low	Historical Racism. Roots in voting suppression laws.
Sold down the river	● Low	Slavery Imagery. Refers to selling enslaved people.
Master / Slave	● Low	Slavery Imagery. Tech terminology. Use "Primary/Replica".
Whitelist / Blacklist	● Low	Color Symbolism. Black = bad, White = good. Use "Allow/Block".
Brown bag	● Low	Colorism. Historical skin tone tests. Use "Lunch & Learn".
Cakewalk	● Low	Slavery Origin. Mockery of enslaved people's dance.

2. Gender, Sex, & Sexual Orientation

Sources: [DGHS Dataset \(Hate Class\)](#), [BBC Worklife: Coded Language](#), [Textio: Gender Bias](#)

Term / Phrase	Severity	Context / Rationale
Cunt / Twat / Bitch	● High	Slur (Misogynistic). Top frequency in DGHS/ConvAbuse.
Fag / Faggot / Dyke	● High	Slur (LGBTQ+). High frequency in MLMA. Zero tolerance.
Tranny / She-male / Trap	● High	Slur (Trans). Dehumanizing and fetishizing.
Sissy / Soy boy	● High	Toxic Masculinity. Attacks men for perceived femininity.
Feminazi	● High	Misogyny. Equates advocacy with Nazism (MLMA top term).
"Diversity Hire"	● High	Harassment. Implies incompetence based on identity.
Bossy / Feisty / Sassy	● Medium	Gendered Stereotype. Applied to assertive women, not men.
Hysterical / Emotional / Dramatic	● Medium	Gaslighting. Dismisses women's concerns as irrational.
Shrill / Abrasive	● Medium	Tone Policing. Criticizes women's communication style.
"Smile more"	● Medium	Sexism. Policing women's appearance/behavior.
Aggressive (for women)	● Medium	Double Standard. Men are "leaders"; women are "aggressive".

Mommy track	 Medium	Career Bias. Assuming mothers are less committed.
Manning / Manpower	 Low	Exclusionary. Use "Staffing" and "Workforce".
Guys (for mixed groups)	 Low	Exclusionary. Centers men as the default. Use "Folks/Team".
Chairman / Fireman	 Low	Exclusionary. Use "Chair," "Firefighter".
"Ballsy" / "Grow a pair."	 Low	Genital Metaphor. Equates courage with male anatomy.

3. Disability, Mental Health, & Neurodiversity

Sources: [MLMA Dataset](#), [Inclusive Employers: Microaggressions](#), [ADA: Guidelines for Writing](#)

Term / Phrase	Severity	Context / Rationale
Retard / Retarded	 High	Slur. #1 abusive term in MLMA dataset.
Mongoloid	 High	Slur. An archaic offensive term for Down Syndrome.
Spaz / Spastic	 High	Slur. Mockery of motor control disabilities.
Psycho / Schizo / Bipolar	 Medium	Stigmatizing. Trivializes serious conditions.
"Wheelchair bound"	 Medium	Disempowering. Focuses on limitations. Use "Wheelchair user".

"Suffers from..."	● Medium	Victimizing. Use "Has [condition]".
"Special needs"	● Medium	Euphemism. Often patronizing. Use "Disability".
Crazy / Insane / Bonkers	● Low	Ableist Metaphor. Equates bad/wild with mental illness.
Lame	● Low	Ableist Metaphor. Original meaning: unable to walk.
Blind spot / Deaf ear	● Low	Ableist Metaphor. Equates sensory loss with ignorance.
OCD (as adjective)	● Low	Trivializing. "I'm so OCD about this" -> "I'm particular".
"Tone deaf"	● Low	Ableist Metaphor. Use "Insensitive".
"Standup meeting"	● Low	Exclusionary. Assumes standing ability. Use "Daily Sync".

4. Age & Generational Bias

Sources: [AARP: Ageist Language](#), [EEOC: Age Discrimination](#)

Term / Phrase	Severity	Context / Rationale
Senile / Geriatric	● High	Ageist Slur. Mockery of older adults.
"OK Boomer"	● Medium	Dismissive. Stereotypes older workers as out of touch.

"Digital Native" (job req)	 Medium	Exclusionary. Code for "young people only".
"Overqualified"	 Medium	Code. Often means "too old / too expensive".
"Young and hungry."	 Medium	Exclusionary. Implies older workers are lazy/slow.
"Senior moment"	 Low	Microaggression. Trivializes memory lapses as age-related.
"Set in their ways."	 Low	Stereotype. Assumes lack of adaptability.
"Fresh / Energetic"	 Low	Bias. Focus on youth over experience.

5. Indigenous & Cultural Appropriation

Sources: [*Indigenous Corporate Training: Terms to Avoid*](#)

Term / Phrase	Severity	Context / Rationale
Indian Giver	 High	Racist Slur. Highly offensive history.
"Off the reservation."	 High	Racist. Refers to confining Indigenous people.
Spirit Animal	 Medium	Appropriation. Sacred concept. Use "Mascot/Favorite".

Powwow	 Medium	Appropriation. Sacred gathering. Use "Meeting/Huddle".
Tribe	 Low	Misleading. Use "Team," "Squad," "Group".
Low on the totem pole	 Low	Misappropriation. Misunderstands cultural hierarchy.
Guru / Ninja / Sherpa	 Low	Appropriation. Trivializes specific cultural titles.

6. Tech-Specific & Recruitment Bias

Sources: [Textio: Job Description Bias](#), [Google ReWork: Unconscious Bias](#)

Term / Phrase	Severity	Context / Rationale
"Culture Fit"	 Medium	Bias Trap. Often means "people like us". Use "Values Add".
"Rockstar" / "Ninja"	 Medium	Masculine Coded. Discourages female applicants.
"Work hard, play hard."	 Medium	Exclusionary. Signals bro-culture / no work-life balance.
Competitive / Dominate	 Medium	Masculine Coded. Appeals more to male candidates.

Nurture / Support	 Medium	Feminine Coded. Often devalues the role's technicality.
Sanity Check	 Low	Ableist. Use "Confidence Check" or "Quick Review".
Dummy / Dummy Value	 Low	Ableist. Use "Placeholder".